

Information Security Incident Report Form

Name: Group 2 - Timothy Loudon, Melvin Viado, Daniel Lindo, Emmanuel Ajayi
Email address: N/A
Telephone/Mobile number: N/A
Date of report: April 22, 2026
Incident detection date: July 2, 2013
Has the incident been resolved (yes/no): yes
Organization name and address: Ubisoft
Incident Overview
Location of incident (site) Ubisoft
Nature of Incident (select all that apply) (a) Suspicious system and network activities (b) Compromise of sensitive information (c) Unauthorized access or attempts to access a system (d) Emails with suspicious attachments or links (e) Denial of service attacks (f) Suspected tampering of electronic devices (g) Malware infection • Cryptlocker • Coin miner • Remote access trojan • Credential harvesting malware • Botnet • Other malware (describe) (h) Reconnaissance (scanning/probing) (i) Social engineering (j) Account compromise
Incident Severity (a) None/Negligible (suspicious activity only) (b) Minor (Impacts single computer, non-privileged account) (c) Moderate (Impacts part of the organization's infrastructure) (d) High (impact's organization's entire infrastructure/privileged accounts) (e) Very High (has impact beyond the organization)
How did the organization become aware of the incident? Ubisoft became aware of the data breach when they found that data had been illegally accessed from their account data based. This discovery was made through their internal security monitoring systems which alerted that their online systems have been breached.
Provide a general description of the incident: Ubisoft experienced a significant data breach affecting around 58 million accounts on July 2013. Usernames and encrypted passwords were exposed due to unauthorized access. The company advised users to change their passwords and to double check that their financial information was compromised during the incident.

Ubisoft properly informed affected the users about the breach and recommended their users to take extra security cautionary measures to ensure their personal information was secured. Ubisoft confirmed that no credit or debit card information was compromised during the breach. After the incident, Ubisoft faced scrutiny because of their security measures, specifically about their password encryption methods.

The breach showed Ubisoft's vulnerabilities in terms of security infrastructure and how they undermined data protection practices in the gaming industry. The data breach serves as a critical reminder for users to maintain strong, unique passwords across various platforms.

Incident Report

Incident Impact (select all that apply)

- ~~(a) Loss of access to services~~
- ~~(b) Loss of productivity~~
- (c) Loss of reputation**
- ~~(d) Loss of revenue~~
- ~~(e) Propagation to other networks~~
- (f) Unauthorized disclosure of data/information**
- ~~(g) Unauthorized modification of data/information~~
- (h) Unknown/Other (please describe): Forced security remediation**

What steps were taken to investigate the nature and severity of the incident?

1. Ubisoft's security teams performed a technical deep dive into the compromised website to identify the specific web vulnerability exploited by the attackers
2. Investigators traced unauthorized access back to the theft of an employee's administrative credentials, determining how the attackers bypassed initial security layers.
3. The team conducted a thorough review of the account management system to verify which specific data fields were accessed; they confirmed that usernames, emails, and hashed passwords were at risk, but financial data was not.
4. Analysts examined network logs to determine the duration of the breach, estimating that the attackers had access for approximately 48 hours before being detected.
5. Ubisoft engaged third-party security specialists and law enforcement to validate their internal findings and ensure no hidden backdoors remained in the network.
6. A technical review was conducted to ensure the password hashes (the encrypted versions of user passwords) remained secure enough to prevent immediate decryption by the attackers.

What systems were impacted?

- **IP addresses of affected systems:**
Not publicly disclosed.
No IP ranges or specific server addresses were disclosed to prevent further targeting.
- **FQDN of affected systems:**
Not publicly disclosed. <https://www.google.com/search?q=account.uplay.com> and *ubi.com* were primary points of user interaction for affected services.
- **Role of affected systems (Domain controller/DNS/DHCP/Web Server):**
Web Server: The initial entry point that is the external-facing website.
Account Database Web Server: The ultimate system target that contained user credentials involving usernames, email addresses, and encrypted passwords.
- **Operating systems of affected systems:**
Not Publicly Disclosed.
Likely a stack of Linux (for web services or databases) and Windows Server (for internal corporate infrastructure).
Operating system of the breached database is kept proprietary.
- **Patch level of affected systems:**
Unknown.
Patch on the website vulnerability is implied.
- **Security software on affected systems:**
Proprietary.
Ubisoft confirmed they collaborated with external security experts and Kaspersky Lab to audit and secure systems after the breach.
- **Physical location of affected systems:**
Likely where, the primary data centers and global IT headquarters are located from Ubisoft (Montreal, Canada or Montreuil, France)
- **Additional details:**
Usernames, email addresses, and encrypted passwords were compromised.
Security researches criticized Ubisoft for potentially using MD5 hashing without salts or something similar to that effect.
Encrypted passwords were vulnerable to Rainbow Table attacks.
The breach was an attack on the global account management system which forced a password reset for all users.
No credit card or payment information was accessed.

Which applications were impacted?

The breach impacted the entire Uplay ecosystem which served as a lay for most digital and online services provided by Ubisoft. Any application or service that required a Uplay login was a part of the affected surface because the breach targeted the Global Account Database.

The primary launcher for Windows, Uplay PC Client, was impacted and users had to be forced into a logout and password reset in the client to secure their accounts. The official website Ubi.com was the main corporate and community portal where users can manage their own profiles and

participate in forums. The Ubisoft Support Portal service was considered at risk for social engineering attacks using leaked email addresses because the support tickets were tied to the same Global Account Database.

Online features with major titles including Assassin's Creed, Far Cry, and Tom Clancy's Splinter Cell were affected because they relied on Uplay login. These games had multiplayer, Uplay rewards, mobile loadout managers, and browser-based features that were affected.

What unauthorized data access occurred?

Unique identifiers (usernames) for Uplay and Ubisoft accounts.

Email addresses which are the primary point of contact for users.

Encrypted passwords that were not stored in plain text. These passwords appeared to be MD5 hashes which can be cracked with rainbow tables and brute-force attacks.

Which privileged user accounts were impacted?

In Ubisoft's communications, they stated that their credentials were stolen and used to access their online network implying that the attackers gained access to an account with high-level permissions. The compromised credentials allowed attackers to audit internal access rights and view proprietary documentations on various platforms during their windows of unauthorized access.

Which unprivileged user accounts were impacted?

Around 58 million unprivileged player and customer user accounts were compromised by the global account management database breach.

Which third parties were impacted (Vendors/Contractors/Partners)

No third parties were impacted. Although, many users tend to recycle their login credentials across platforms which creates a risk for unrelated third-party services such as banks and social media sites.

Sensitivity of Compromised Data (select all that apply)

- (a) **Confidential/Sensitive data**
- (b) **Non-sensitive data**
- (c) ~~Publicly available data~~
- (d) ~~Financial data~~
- (e) ~~Personally identifiable information (PII)~~
- (f) ~~Intellectual property~~
- (g) ~~Critical infrastructure/key resources~~
- (h) ~~Other (describe)~~

What would the consequences be of the data that was accessed in an unauthorized manner becoming public?

Credential stuff attacks across the internet would be the primary consequence.

Hackers can make automated scripts to attempt logins on accounts across platforms because users reuse the same credentials.

Attacks can create convincing emails that appear to be from Ubisoft to execute targeted phishing campaigns.

What is the time frame of the incident?**Suspected initial date/time of compromise:**

Roughly two days prior to discovery

Detection date/time:

July 2, 2013

Incident remediation date/time:

Immediate - July 2, 2013

How did the breach occur? (select all that apply)

- ~~(a) DDoS~~
- ~~(b) Malware~~
- ~~(c) Misconfiguration~~
- ~~(d) Phishing~~
- (e) **Vulnerability exploit**
- ~~(f) Unknown~~

Suspected perpetrators:

- ~~(a) Insider~~
- ~~(b) Former staff~~
- (c) **Other**
- ~~(d) Unknown~~

Estimated total cost incurred: (Cost to contain incident, restore systems, notify stakeholders)

Ubisoft did not publicly disclose specific financial costs.

Ponemon Institute's Cost of Data Breach Study estimate the data breach cost in America was around \$5.4 million.

Per-record cost for attacks averaged \$227.

The breach involved 58 million users.

Costs focused on deployment of password resets, hiring security experts, and administrative overhead.

What steps have been taken to remediate the cause of and vulnerabilities related to the incident?

Ubisoft immediately closed the website containing the vulnerability.

Global mandatory password reset for all users was initiated.

Dedicated support forum and specialized password reset page was established.

Collaborated with internal and external security experts including law enforcement authorities for an infrastructure audit.

Ubisoft stated that their security teams are continuously exploring defensive measures.

What additional controls should be in place to prevent the incident reoccurring?

Ubisoft implemented multi-factor authentication ensuring that stolen credentials alone cannot grant account access.

Zero Trust Architecture requires continuous verification.

Principle of Least Privilege to prevent lateral movement within the user database.

Automated patch management.

Web Application Firewalls.

Credential Monitoring Services.

Penetration Testing.

Vulnerability Disclosure Program allowing hackers to report vulnerabilities.

Do any authorities need to be notified about the details of the incident?

Ubisoft was required to notify law enforcement agencies and data protection authorities. Notifying was essential for attack investigation and documentation. Companies must provide formal reports to government regulators about the nature and details of the incident.

Additional impact information:

The breach has long term brand trust and secondary security risks.
The breach Served as a case study in credential stuffing as credentials appeared on the dark web for years.
The breach brought light to the player criticism on Ubisoft's data practices.
The breach forced a permanent change in Ubisoft's communication strategy towards more vocal commitment to user privacy and account security.